

NFL Innovation HUB - Pitchtape Configuration Guide

Document Owner: NOVATE Labs

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Executive Summary

This document specifies the exact configuration requirements for Pitchtape to serve as the Stage 1 (Discovery) intake interface for the NFL Draft Innovation Challenge 2026. Pitchtape will handle vendor submissions and initial review, while Sentrais orchestrates all subsequent stages (Validation, Evaluation, Selection) and maintains the authoritative Evidence Ledger.

Key Integration Points:

- Pitchtape → Sentrais: Real-time submission data via webhooks
 - Sentrais → Pitchtape: Status updates for applicant dashboard
 - NFL Access: Sentrais dashboard via AWS VPC (secure, NFL-owned infrastructure)
 - Data Sovereignty: Sentrais replicates all Pitchtape data to Sentrais-owned PostgreSQL database
-

Section 1: Pitchtape Workspace Configuration

1.1 Workspace Setup

Workspace Name: NFL Draft Innovation Challenge 2026

Workspace URL: <https://nfl-draft-2026.pitchtape.com> (or custom domain: <https://challenge.nflinnovationhub.com>)

Branding Requirements:

- **Logo:** NFL Innovation HUB logo (provided as SVG, 500x200px)
- **Primary Color:** NFL Blue ([#013369](#))
- **Secondary Color:** NFL Red ([#D50A0A](#))
- **Accent Color:** Silver ([#A5ACAF](#))

- **Background:** White (#FFFFFF)
- **Custom Domain:** nfl.com/innovationhub.com (DNS CNAME configured by NFL IT)

Welcome Email Template:

None

Subject: Welcome to the NFL Draft Innovation Challenge 2026

Hi [First Name],

Welcome to the NFL Draft Innovation Challenge—where innovation earns its Draft pick.

You've taken the first step toward joining the NFL's Innovation HUB ecosystem. Here's what happens next:

NEXT STEPS

1. Complete Your Submission (Deadline: December 30, 2026)
Log in to your portal and follow the 6-step guided wizard.

[Complete Your Submission →]

2. Focus on These Key Areas:
 - Your innovation's alignment to OnePass
 - A clear 3-minute video pitch
 - Technical readiness and MVP status

3. Track Your Progress
You'll receive updates as your submission advances through our 4-stage evaluation process:

Stage 1: Discovery (Scouting)

Stage 2: Validation (Combine)
Stage 3: Evaluation (War Room)
Stage 4: Selection (Draft Day)

NEED HELP?

- Submission Guidelines: [Link]
- Video Recording Tips: [Link]
- OnePass Integration FAQ: [Link]
- Contact Support: innovationhub@nfl.com

Good luck, and we look forward to reviewing your innovation.

The NFL Innovation HUB Team

1.2 Submission Form Configuration (6-Step Wizard)

Form Structure: Multi-step wizard with auto-save and progress indicator

STEP 1: Innovation Profile

Fields:

Field Name	Type	Required	Validation Rules	Pitchtape Field ID
Company/Organization Name	Text (100 chars)	Yes	Alphanumeric + spaces	company_name
Innovation Name	Text (100 chars)	Yes	Alphanumeric + spaces	innovation_name

One-Sentence Description	Text (200 chars)	Yes	Max 200 chars	tagline
Primary Category	Single Select Dropdown	Yes	See categories below	primary_category
MVP Status	Single Select Radio	Yes	See options below	mvp_status

Primary Category Options:

None

- Fan Journey & Personalization
- Local Monetization & Commerce
- Event Discovery & Global Engagement

MVP Status Options:

None

- Deployed in production (with customers)
- Beta/pilot stage (live testing)
- Working prototype (functional demo)
- Concept stage (idea only) [AUTO-DISQUALIFIES]

Conditional Logic:

- IF `mvp_status == "Concept stage"` → Display message: "The NFL Draft Challenge requires a working prototype or deployed product. Please return when your MVP is ready." → Prevent submission advancement

Progress Indicator: Step 1 of 6

STEP 2: Innovation Video

Fields:

Field Name	Type	Required	Validation Rules	Pitchtape Field ID
------------	------	----------	------------------	--------------------

Video Recording/Upload	Video (max 3 min)	Yes	MP4, MOV, WebM, max 500MB	<code>pitch_video</code>
Structured Prompts	Video segments	No (optional)	3 prompts, 30 sec each	<code>video_prompts</code>

Video Prompts (Optional Guided Recording):

Pitchtape's multi-topic video recorder should present these prompts sequentially:

1. **Prompt 1** (30 seconds): "What problem does your innovation solve for NFL fans or operations?"
2. **Prompt 2** (30 seconds): "How does your solution integrate with OnePass or NFL systems?"
3. **Prompt 3** (30 seconds): "What makes your solution ready for NFL scale and security requirements?"

Auto-Stitching: If applicant uses guided prompts, Pitchtape auto-stitches segments into single 90-second video

Alternative: Applicant can upload pre-recorded 3-minute video (bypasses prompts)

Progress Indicator:  Step 2 of 6

STEP 3: Technical Documentation

Fields:

Field Name	Type	Required	Validation Rules	Pitchtape Field ID
Pitch Deck	File Upload	Yes	PDF or PPT, max 50MB	<code>pitch_deck</code>
Technical Architecture	File Upload	No	PDF, diagram, or doc, max 25MB	<code>tech_architecture</code>
Demo Video/Screenshot	File Upload	No	Video (MP4, max 100MB) or Image (PNG/JPG, max 10MB)	<code>demo_media</code>

Progress Indicator:  Step 3 of 6

STEP 4: OnePass Integration Readiness

Fields:

Field Name	Type	Required	Validation Rules	Pitchtape Field ID
OnePass Components	Multi-Select Checkbox	Yes	At least 1 required	<code>onepass_components</code>
Integration Approach	Single Select Radio	Yes	See options below	<code>integration_approach</code>
Similar Integration Experience	Radio + Text	Yes	Yes (describe) / No	<code>similar_integration</code>

OnePass Components Options:

None

- ☐ Mobile App (iOS/Android)
- ☐ Web Platform
- ☐ In-Venue Experience
- ☐ Ticketing & Commerce
- ☐ Fan Profiles & Personalization
- ☐ Club Systems (local/venue-specific)
- ☐ Broadcast & Media
- ☐ Other: [Text Input]

Integration Approach Options:

None

- ☐ API/SDK integration (preferred)
- ☐ Embedded widget/iframe
- ☐ Standalone with data sync
- ☐ Other: [Text Input]

Similar Integration Experience:

None

- o Yes (describe): [Text Area, 500 chars]
- o No

Progress Indicator: ☒ ☒ ☒ ☒ ☐ Step 4 of 6

STEP 5: Team & Company Background

Fields:

Field Name	Type	Required	Validation Rules	Pitchtape Field ID
Team Members	Repeatable Section	Yes (min 1)	Name, Title, LinkedIn, Bio (50 words)	team_members
Company Stage	Single Select Dropdown	Yes	See options below	company_stage
Company Location	Text (100 chars)	Yes	City, State/Country	company_location
Company Website	URL	Yes	Valid URL format	company_website
Customer Base	Single Select Radio	Yes	B2C / B2B / B2B2C	customer_base

Company Stage Options:

None

- Pre-Seed
- Seed
- Series A
- Series B
- Series C+
- Private/Bootstrapped
- Public Company

Team Member Repeatable Section (Add up to 5 members):

None

Team Member 1

Name: [_____]

Title: [_____]

LinkedIn: [_____]

Bio (50 words): [_____]

[+ Add Team Member]

Progress Indicator: Step 5 of 6

STEP 6: Review & Submit

Fields:

Field Name	Type	Required	Validation Rules	Pitchtape Field ID
Terms & Conditions	Checkbox	Yes	Must check to submit	terms_accepted

Review Screen Layout:

None

Step 6 of 6: Review & Submit

Review your submission before submitting to the NFL Innovation HUB.

✓ Innovation Profile

[Edit]

✓ Innovation Video (2:47)	[Edit]
✓ Pitch Deck (deck.pdf)	[Edit]
✓ OnePass Integration Details	[Edit]
✓ Team & Company Background	[Edit]
By submitting, you agree to the NFL Innovation HUB Terms and acknowledge that your submission will be reviewed by NFL stakeholders. ☐ I agree to the Terms & Conditions	
[Submit to NFL]	
Submission closes: December 30, 2026	

Terms & Conditions Link: <https://nflinnovationhub.com/challenge/terms>

Post-Submission Confirmation:

None

 Submission Received
Thank you for submitting to the NFL Draft Innovation Challenge! Your innovation is now entering our Discovery phase. You'll receive a confirmation email within 24 hours, and a status update within 2 weeks.

```
|
| Submission ID: #2026-[AUTO-INCREMENT]
|
| Next Steps:
| • Track your status in the Applicant Portal
| • Respond promptly if we request clarifications
| • Check email for Stage 2 (Validation) invitations
|
| [Return to Dashboard]
```

1.3 Applicant Dashboard Configuration

Dashboard URL: <https://nfl-draft-2026.pitchtape.com/dashboard>

Dashboard Components:

1. **Submission Status Card**
2. **Progress Tracker** (4-stage visualization)
3. **Action Items** (urgent notifications)
4. **Reviewer Feedback** (anonymized)
5. **Contact Support**

Dashboard Layout:

None

```
|
| MY SUBMISSION DASHBOARD
|
|-----|
|
| Submission ID: #2026-0128
| Innovation: [Your Innovation Name]
| Category: Fan Journey & Personalization
|
```

CURRENT STATUS: ● STAGE 1 - DISCOVERY (SCOUTING)

PROGRESS TRACKER

- | | | |
|---|---|-------------|
|  | Stage 1: Discovery | In Progress |
| | • Submission received: Jan 28, 2026 | |
| | • Reviewer evaluations: 2 of 5 complete | |
| | • Estimated decision: Feb 15, 2026 | |
| <hr/> | | |
|  | Stage 2: Validation | Pending |
| | • Expected notification: Late February | |
| <hr/> | | |
|  | Stage 3: Evaluation | Pending |
| <hr/> | | |
|  | Stage 4: Selection | Pending |
| | • NFL Draft Week: April 24-26, 2026 | |

ACTION ITEMS

-  No action items at this time.
We'll notify you if we need additional information.

[\[Edit Submission\]](#) [\[Contact Support\]](#)

Status Update Source: Sentrais pushes status updates to Pitchtape via API (see Section 3.3)

Progress Stages (Display Names):

- Stage 1: Discovery (Scouting)
- Stage 2: Validation (Combine)
- Stage 3: Evaluation (War Room)
- Stage 4: Selection (Draft Day)

Section 2: Reviewer Workspace Configuration

2.1 Reviewer Account Setup

Reviewer Roles:

Role	Count	NFL Stakeholders	Pitchtape Permissions
IT Lead	2	To Be Assigned + 1	Evaluate Technical Readiness, OnePass Integration
Operations Lead	2	To Be Assigned team	Evaluate Operational Feasibility
Media Lead	2	To Be Assigned	Evaluate Broadcast Integration, Content Potential
Sponsorship Lead	1	To Be Assigne	Evaluate Monetization, Partner Fit
Admin	2	NOVATE (Knox and Tionna)	Full access (all reviews, settings, exports)

Total Reviewer Accounts: 9

Reviewer Invitation Email Template:

None

Subject: You're Invited to Review NFL Draft Challenge Submissions

Hi [First Name],

You've been selected as a reviewer for the NFL Draft Innovation Challenge 2026. Your expertise in [domain] is critical to identifying the best innovations for the NFL ecosystem.

Your Reviewer Portal: [Login Link]

What to Expect:

|| FILTERS

Category: [All Categories ▼]

| | Status: [Pending My Review ▼]
| |
| | Priority: [Show All ▼]

Priority: [Show All ▼]
Assigned Date: [Last 7 Days ▼]

| | Assigned Date: [Last 7 Days ▼]

```
7 | SUBMISSION: [Vendor A] - AI Personalization Platform
8 |
```

#2026-0042 | Fan Journey & Personalization

🎥 PITCH VIDEO	📊 AI-GENERATED SUMMARY
(2:47)	

(2:47)

🎥 PITCH VIDEO	📊 AI-GENERATED SUMMARY
(2:47)	

		 PITCH VIDEO		 AI-GENERATED SUMMARY	
		(2:47)			

					Solution: AI-powered fan		
			[► Play]		personalization engine that		
					analyzes behavior across NFL		
					digital properties to deliver		
					tailored content.		
					OnePass Integration: REST API		
			 DECK		connecting to fan profile system.		
			(12 slides)				
			[View PDF]		Team: 3 founders (ex-Google,		
					ex-Meta), Series A stage.		
					Key Strengths: Strong ML/AI		
			 ONEPASS		expertise, proven personalization		
			DETAILS		in adjacent sports.		
			[View]				
					Potential Concerns: Unproven at		
					NFL scale, security compliance TBD.		

YOUR EVALUATION (IT LEAD PERSPECTIVE)	
Technical Readiness (40% weight)	★★★★☆ 4/5
Comments: [Strong API design, needs security review]	
OnePass Integration (30% weight)	★★★★☆ 4/5
Comments: [Clear integration path, standard REST]	
Confidence Level: ☐ Low ☒ Medium ☐ High	
Open Questions for Vendor:	
[Can you provide SOC2 compliance documentation?]	
[Save Draft] [Submit Review]	

Confidence Level: Low / Medium / High

Open Questions for Vendor: Text area (1000 chars)

Operations Lead Criteria:

None

1. Operational Feasibility (40% weight)
2. Deployment Complexity (30% weight)
3. Scalability (20% weight)
4. Change Management (10% weight)

Confidence Level: Low / Medium / High

Open Questions: Text area

Media Lead Criteria:

None

1. Broadcast Integration (40% weight)
2. Content Generation Potential (30% weight)
3. Fan Experience Enhancement (20% weight)
4. Media Rights Compatibility (10% weight)

Confidence Level: Low / Medium / High

Open Questions: Text area

Sponsorship Lead Criteria:

None

1. Monetization Potential (40% weight)
2. Partner Fit (30% weight)
3. Revenue Model Clarity (20% weight)
4. Go-to-Market Readiness (10% weight)

Confidence Level: Low / Medium / High

Open Questions: Text area

2.4 AI Summary Configuration

AI Summary Generator: Pitchtape's OpenAI integration (non-training use)

Summary Prompt Template:

None

Analyze this NFL Innovation Challenge submission and generate a concise summary (200 words max) covering:

1. Solution Overview: What problem does it solve?
2. OnePass Integration: How does it connect to NFL systems?
3. Team Background: Key qualifications
4. Key Strengths: Top 2-3 differentiators
5. Potential Concerns: Top 1-2 risks or gaps

Submission Data:

- Company: [company_name]
- Innovation: [innovation_name]
- Category: [primary_category]
- Video Transcript: [video_transcript]
- Pitch Deck Text: [extracted_text_from_deck]
- OnePass Components: [onepass_components]
- Integration Approach: [integration_approach]
- Team: [team_members]

Output Format: Structured paragraphs (not bullet points).

Tone: Professional, objective, data-driven.

AI Summary Display: Shown in reviewer workspace (top-right panel, always visible)

2.5 Structured Q&A System Configuration

Q&A Workflow:

1. Reviewer asks question in "Open Questions" field
2. Question routed to Sentrais (via API sync)
3. Sentrais routes to vendor via email (not open chat)
4. Vendor responds via Pitchtape dashboard
5. Response synced to Sentrais Evidence Ledger
6. All assigned reviewers see Q&A thread (transparency)

Q&A Notification Email (to vendor):

None

Subject: NFL Reviewer Question for [Innovation Name]

Hi [Vendor First Name],

An NFL reviewer has a question about your submission:

QUESTION

"Can you provide SOC2 compliance documentation?"

Please respond by [Due Date]. Your response will be visible to all assigned reviewers.

[Respond to Question →]

Questions? Contact innovationhub@nfl.com

Section 3: API Integration & Webhook Configuration

3.1 Sentrais Webhook Endpoints (Pitchtape → Sentrais)

Sentrais Base URL:

<https://sentrais.nfl360.aws.vpc.internal/api/orchestration>

Note: Sentrais is hosted in NFL's AWS VPC. Pitchtape must be whitelisted in NFL's security group to send webhooks. Provide Pitchtape's outbound IP addresses for whitelisting.

Webhook 1: Submission Ingestion

Event: Submission completed (all 6 steps, Terms accepted)

Pitchtape Webhook URL: POST

<https://sentrais.nfl360.aws.vpc.internal/api/orchestration/submissions/ingest>

Authentication: HMAC-SHA256 signature (shared secret: [REDACTED - provided separately])

Payload:

json

```
JSON
{
  "event_type": "submission.completed",
  "timestamp": "2026-01-28T14:32:00Z",
  "pitchtape_submission_id": "PT-2026-0128",
  "initiative": {
    "id": "nfl-draft-challenge-2026",
    "name": "NFL Draft Innovation Challenge 2026"
  },
  "vendor": {
    "company_name": "TGI Virtual Signage",
    "contact_email": "contact@tgi.com",
    "contact_phone": "+1-555-123-4567",
    "website": "https://tgi.com",
    "location": "San Francisco, CA",
    "company_stage": "Series A",
```

```
"customer_base": "B2B2C",
"team_members": [
  {
    "name": "Jane Doe",
    "title": "CEO",
    "linkedin": "https://linkedin.com/in/janedoe",
    "bio": "Former VP Engineering at Google, 15 years ML/AI
experience..."
  }
],
},
"innovation": {
  "name": "AI-Powered Virtual Signage",
  "tagline": "Dynamic broadcast overlays driven by real-time
fan sentiment",
  "category": "fan_journey_personalization",
  "description": "Full text from submission form...",
  "mvp_status": "deployed_in_production",
  "video": {
    "url": "https://pitchtape-cdn.com/videos/PT-2026-0128.mp4",
    "duration_seconds": 167,
    "transcript": "Hi, I'm Jane Doe from TGI..."
  },
  "pitch_deck": {
    "url":
"https://pitchtape-cdn.com/files/PT-2026-0128-deck.pdf",
    "filename": "TGI_NFLDraft_Deck.pdf",
    "size_bytes": 5242880
  },
  "tech_architecture": {
    "url":
"https://pitchtape-cdn.com/files/PT-2026-0128-arch.pdf",
    "filename": "TGI_Architecture.pdf"
  },
  "demo_media": null
},
},
```

```

    "onepass_integration": {
      "components": ["mobile_app", "web_platform",
"broadcast_media"],
      "integration_approach": "api_sdk",
      "similar_integration": {
        "has_experience": true,
        "description": "Integrated with NBA League Pass and MLB At
Bat using REST APIs"
      }
    },
    "submitted_at": "2026-01-28T14:32:00Z"
  }

```

Expected Sentrais Response (201 Created):

json

```

JSON
{
  "innovation_id": "INNO-2026-0128",
  "orchestration_status": "discovery_submitted",
  "zone_placement": "incubation",
  "next_stage": "discovery_review",
  "assigned_reviewers": [
    "aaron.amendola@nfl.com",
    "tracy.rodberg@nfl.com",
    "brad.boim@nfl.com",
    "dan.commercial@nfl.com"
  ],
  "estimated_review_completion": "2026-02-15T00:00:00Z"
}

```

Error Handling:

- If Sentrais returns 4xx/5xx, Pitchtape should retry with exponential backoff (max 5 retries)
- Log webhook failures in Pitchtape admin console

- Notify NOVATE admin (tye@novate.com) if webhook fails after 5 retries
-

Webhook 2: Reviewer Activity Sync

Event: Reviewer submits evaluation (ratings + comments)

Pitchtape Webhook URL: POST

<https://sentrais.nfl360.aws.vpc.internal/api/orchestration/evidence/reviewer-activity>

Payload:

json

JSON

```
{
  "event_type": "review.submitted",
  "timestamp": "2026-02-05T09:15:00Z",
  "pitchtape_submission_id": "PT-2026-0128",
  "innovation_id": "INNO-2026-0128",
  "reviewer": {
    "id": "aaron.amendola@nfl.com",
    "name": "Aaron Amendola",
    "role": "IT Lead"
  },
  "evaluation": {
    "criteria": {
      "technical_readiness": {
        "score": 4,
        "weight": 0.40,
        "comment": "Strong API design, needs security review"
      },
      "onepass_integration": {
        "score": 4,
        "weight": 0.30,
        "comment": "Clear integration path, standard REST"
      },
      "security_compliance": {
```

```

        "score": 3,
        "weight": 0.20,
        "comment": "SOC2 docs pending, needs follow-up"
    },
    "data_architecture": {
        "score": 5,
        "weight": 0.10,
        "comment": "Well-designed data model"
    }
},
"composite_score": 3.9,
"confidence_level": "medium",
"open_questions": "Can you provide SOC2 compliance documentation?",
"ai_summary": "Solution demonstrates clear OnePass integration with REST API. Technical architecture is sound, but security compliance needs verification."
},
"submitted_at": "2026-02-05T09:15:00Z"
}

```

Expected Sentrais Response (201 Created):

json

```

JSON
{
  "evidence_id": "EVID-2026-0432",
  "stored_in_ledger": true,
  "innovation_id": "INNO-2026-0128",
  "all_reviewers_complete": false,
  "completed_reviewers": 2,
  "pending_reviewers": 3,
  "stage_gate_status": "awaiting_additional_reviewers"
}

```

Stage Gate Trigger:

- When `all_reviewers_complete == true`, Sentrais calculates composite score
 - If `composite_score >= 75%` → Advance to Stage 2 (Validation)
 - If `composite_score < 75%` → Request more info or decline
-

Webhook 3: Q&A Interaction

Event: Vendor responds to reviewer question

Pitchtape Webhook URL: POST

`https://sentrais.nfl360.aws.vpc.internal/api/orchestration/evidence/qa-response`

Payload:

json

JSON

```
{
  "event_type": "qa.vendor_response",
  "timestamp": "2026-02-07T14:20:00Z",
  "pitchtape_submission_id": "PT-2026-0128",
  "innovation_id": "INNO-2026-0128",
  "question_id": "QA-2026-0089",
  "reviewer": {
    "id": "aaron.amendola@nfl.com",
    "name": "Aaron Amendola",
    "role": "IT Lead"
  },
  "question": "Can you provide SOC2 compliance documentation?",
  "vendor_response": "Yes, we completed SOC2 Type II certification in August 2025. Attached is our audit report. [link]",
  "attachments": [
    {
      "url": "https://pitchtape-cdn.com/files/PT-2026-0128-soc2.pdf",
      "filename": "TGI_SOC2_Report_2025.pdf",
      "size_bytes": 1048576
    }
  ]
}
```

```

    }
  ],
  "responded_at": "2026-02-07T14:20:00Z"
}

```

Expected Sentrais Response (201 Created):

json

```

JSON
{
  "evidence_id": "EVID-2026-0433",
  "stored_in_ledger": true,
  "qa_id": "QA-2026-0089",
  "status": "answered",
  "visible_to_all_reviewers": true
}
...

```

3.2 Sentrais → Pitchtape API Calls (Status Updates)

****Sentrais API Client Configuration**:**

****Pitchtape API Base URL**:** ``https://api.pitchtape.com/v1``

****Authentication**:** Bearer token (Pitchtape provides API key)

API Call 1: Update Submission Status

****Trigger**:** Sentrais advances submission to new stage

```
**Endpoint**: `PATCH
https://api.pitchtape.com/v1/submissions/{pitchtape_submission_id}
/status`

**Headers**:
`
Authorization: Bearer {PITCHTAPE_API_KEY}
Content-Type: application/json
`
```

Request Body:

json

```
JSON
{
  "sentrais_innovation_id": "INNO-2026-0128",
  "orchestration_status": "validation_in_progress",
  "stage": 2,
  "stage_name": "Validation (Combine)",
  "applicant_visible_message": "Congratulations! Your innovation
has advanced to Stage 2: Validation. You'll receive a demo
scheduling email within 48 hours.",
  "internal_notes": "POC testing with HawkEye, ChyronHego, and
Genius comparison framework",
  "updated_at": "2026-02-10T10:00:00Z"
}
```

Expected Pitchtape Response (200 OK):

json

```
JSON
{
  "pitchtape_submission_id": "PT-2026-0128",
  "status_updated": true,
  "applicant_notified": true,
  "dashboard_updated": true
}
```

```
}  
...
```

****Applicant Dashboard Update**:** Pitchtape should update dashboard to show:

...

CURRENT STATUS:  STAGE 2 - VALIDATION (COMBINE)

 Stage 1: Discovery Completed Feb 10, 2026

- Submission qualified
- Category alignment confirmed

 Stage 2: Validation In Progress

- Demo scheduled: [Awaiting confirmation]
- POC testing: Pending
- Outstanding questions: 0

 Stage 3: Evaluation Pending

 Stage 4: Selection Pending

API Call 2: Send Notification Email

Trigger: Sentrais needs to notify vendor (stage transition, demo invite, Q&A response)

Endpoint: POST <https://api.pitchtape.com/v1/notifications/send>

Request Body:

json

JSON

```
{  
  "submission_id": "PT-2026-0128",  
  "template": "stage_transition_validation",  
  "recipient": "contact@tgi.com",  
  "cc": ["jane.doe@tgi.com"],  
}
```

```

    "data": {
      "vendor_name": "TGI Virtual Signage",
      "innovation_name": "AI-Powered Virtual Signage",
      "previous_stage": "Discovery (Scouting)",
      "new_stage": "Validation (Combine)",
      "next_steps": "Schedule your demo using this link:
https://nfl360.com/challenge/demos/INNO-2026-0128",
      "demo_prep_guide_url":
"https://nfl360.com/challenge/demo-guide",
      "contact_email": "innovationhub@nfl.com"
    }
  }
}

```

Expected Pitchtape Response (201 Created):

json

```

JSON
{
  "notification_id": "NOTIF-2026-0234",
  "email_sent": true,
  "sent_at": "2026-02-10T10:05:00Z",
  "recipient": "contact@tgi.com",
  "cc": ["jane.doe@tgi.com"]
}
...

```

****Email Templates Required**** (Pitchtape Configuration):

1. `stage\_transition\_validation` (Discovery → Validation)
2. `stage\_transition\_evaluation` (Validation → Evaluation)
3. `stage\_transition\_selection` (Evaluation → Selection)
4. `demo\_invitation` (Validation stage demo scheduling)
5. `reviewer\_question` (Q&A from reviewer)
6. `decline\_notification` (Did not advance from Discovery)
7. `winner\_announcement` (Draft Day selection)

3.3 Webhook Security Configuration

****Authentication Method****: HMAC-SHA256 signature

****Shared Secret****: `[REDACTED - provided via secure channel]`

****Signature Header****: `X-Pitchtape-Signature`

****Signature Algorithm****:

```

HMAC-SHA256(shared\_secret, request\_body\_json)

#### Sentrais Verification Logic:

javascript

JavaScript

```
const crypto = require('crypto');

function verifyWebhook(req) {
 const signature = req.headers['x-pitchtape-signature'];
 const body = JSON.stringify(req.body);
 const expectedSignature = crypto
 .createHmac('sha256', SHARED_SECRET)
 .update(body)
 .digest('hex');

 return signature === expectedSignature;
}
```

#### IP Whitelisting:

- Pitchtape Outbound IPs: [Pitchtape to provide]
- Add to NFL AWS VPC Security Group inbound rules (HTTPS only, port 443)

---

## Section 4: Data Export & Migration Planning

### 4.1 Data Export Requirements (for Pitchtape Deprecation)

**Export Trigger:** Q4 2026 (when custom Sentrais intake module is ready)

**Export Format:** JSON (line-delimited, one submission per line)

**Export Endpoint:** GET <https://api.pitchtape.com/v1/exports/submissions>

**Query Parameters:**

- `initiative_id=nfl-draft-challenge-2026`
- `format=jsonl` (JSON Lines)
- `include_files=true` (download URLs for videos, decks)

**Expected Export Structure:**

json

JSON

```
{
 "pitchtape_submission_id": "PT-2026-0128",
 "submitted_at": "2026-01-28T14:32:00Z",
 "vendor": { ... },
 "innovation": { ... },
 "reviews": [
 {
 "reviewer_id": "aaron.amendola@nfl.com",
 "submitted_at": "2026-02-05T09:15:00Z",
 "evaluation": { ... }
 }
],
 "qa_thread": [
 {
 "question_id": "QA-2026-0089",
 "question": "...",
 "response": "...",
 }
]
}
```

```

 "timestamps": { ... }
 },
 "status_history": [
 {
 "status": "discovery_submitted",
 "timestamp": "2026-01-28T14:32:00Z"
 },
 {
 "status": "validation_in_progress",
 "timestamp": "2026-02-10T10:00:00Z"
 }
]
}
...

```

**\*\*File Download\*\*:** All videos and PDFs must remain accessible via CDN URLs for **12** months post-export

---

### ### 4.2 Historical Data Retention

**\*\*NFL Requirement\*\*:** All submissions, reviews, videos, and Q&A threads must be archived in Sentrais

**\*\*Archive Location\*\*:** AWS S3  
 (`s3://nfl-innovation-hub-archive/pitchtape-2026/`)

**\*\*Retention Policy\*\*:** **7** years (NFL standard for vendor evaluation records)

**\*\*Migration Script\*\*:** NOVATE provides Python script to import Pitchtape export into Sentrais database

---

## ## Section 5: NFL Access Model (AWS VPC Integration)

### ### 5.1 Network Architecture

#### **\*\*Sentrais Hosting\*\*:**

- **\*\*AWS Region\*\*:** us-east-1 (Virginia)
- **\*\*VPC\*\*:** NFL Innovation HUB VPC (`vpc-nfl-innohub-prod`)
- **\*\*Subnets\*\*:** Private subnets (no direct internet access)
- **\*\*Load Balancer\*\*:** Application Load Balancer (ALB) in public subnet
- **\*\*Domain\*\*:** `sentrais.nfl360.aws.vpc.internal` (internal DNS only)

#### **\*\*NFL360 Dashboard Embedding\*\*:**

- NFL360 frontend (hosted in NFL corporate VPC) embeds Sentrais dashboards via iframe
- Authentication: NFL365 SS0 (Azure AD SAML integration)
- Network: VPC peering between NFL corporate VPC and NFL Innovation HUB VPC

---

### ### 5.2 NFL Stakeholder Access

**\*\*Access Method\*\*:** NFL360 web application (browser-based, no VPN required)

#### **\*\*Authentication Flow\*\*:**

...

NFL Stakeholder logs into NFL360

↓

Azure AD SS0 (SAML)

↓

NFL360 validates user (Tracy, Dan, Aaron, Brad, etc.)

↓

NFL360 embeds Sentrais dashboard (iframe)

↓

Sentraais validates JWT token (issued by NFL360)

↓

User sees role-appropriate dashboard (Executive, PMO, Reviewer)  
...

**\*\*No VPN Required\*\***: All access via HTTPS through NFL corporate network

**\*\*Mobile Access\*\***: NFL360 mobile app (iOS/Android) also embeds Sentrais dashboards

---

### ### 5.3 Pitchtape → Sentrais Network Path

**\*\*Challenge\*\***: Pitchtape (external SaaS) needs to send webhooks to Sentrais (internal VPC)

**\*\*Solution\*\***: AWS API Gateway as public-facing webhook receiver

**\*\*Architecture\*\***:  
...

Pitchtape (internet)

↓ HTTPS POST (webhook)

AWS API Gateway (public endpoint)

- URL:

<https://api-gateway.nfl-innohub.aws.com/webhooks/pitchtape>

- Authentication: HMAC signature validation

↓ Forward to internal VPC

AWS Lambda (VPC-attached)

- Validates HMAC signature

- Forwards to Sentrais internal endpoint

↓

Sentraais (private VPC)

```
- URL:
http://sentrais-internal-alb.vpc.internal/api/orchestration/...
```
```

```
**Pitchtape Configuration**:
```

```
- **Webhook URL**:
`https://api-gateway.nfl-innohub.aws.com/webhooks/pitchtape/submis
sions`
- **Authentication**: HMAC-SHA256 (shared secret)
- **IP Whitelisting**: Not required (API Gateway is public, but
HMAC-protected)
```

```
---
```

Section 6: Testing & Validation Plan

6.1 Phase 1: Pitchtape Configuration Testing (Week 1)

```
**Objective**: Validate Pitchtape workspace configuration
```

```
**Test Cases**:
```

Test ID	Test Case	Expected Result	Pass/Fail
PT-001	Create test submission (all 6 steps)	Submission ID generated, confirmation email sent	[]
PT-002	Upload 3-minute video	Video uploaded, playback works in dashboard	[]
PT-003	Upload pitch deck PDF (50MB)	PDF uploaded, viewable in reviewer workspace	[]
PT-004	Conditional logic: Select "Concept stage" MVP	Form blocks submission, displays disqualification message	[]
PT-005	Applicant dashboard displays submission status	Dashboard shows "Stage 1: Discovery (Scouting)"	[]
PT-006	Reviewer login and assignment	Reviewer sees assigned submissions in workspace	[]

| PT-007 | Reviewer submits evaluation (4 stars, comment) |
Evaluation saved, confirmation displayed | [] |
| PT-008 | AI summary generation | Summary appears in reviewer
workspace | [] |
| PT-009 | Q&A: Reviewer asks question | Vendor receives email
notification, can respond in dashboard | [] |
| PT-010 | Q&A: Vendor responds | All reviewers see response in
workspace | [] |

****Test Submissions****: NOVATE creates 5 test submissions with
realistic data

****Test Reviewers****: Aaron, Tracy, Brad, Dan, Tye (5 real NFL
stakeholders)

6.2 Phase 2: Webhook Integration Testing (Week 2-3)

****Objective****: Validate Pitchtape → Sentrais webhook delivery

****Test Cases****:

Test ID	Test Case	Expected Result	Pass/Fail
WH-001	Submission completed	webhook fires	Sentrais receives submission data, returns 201 Created
WH-002	Sentrais creates innovation record	innovation_id generated, data stored in PostgreSQL	
WH-003	Reviewer evaluation	webhook fires	Sentrais receives evaluation data, stores in Evidence Ledger
WH-004	All reviewers complete	→ Stage gate trigger	Sentrais calculates composite score, advances to Stage 2
WH-005	Q&A response	webhook fires	Sentrais stores Q&A in Evidence Ledger

```
| WH-006 | HMAC signature validation | Invalid signature rejected  
with 401 Unauthorized | [ ] |  
| WH-007 | Webhook retry on failure | Pitchtape retries with  
exponential backoff (5 retries max) | [ ] |  
| WH-008 | Sentrais pushes status update to Pitchtape | Applicant  
dashboard updates to show new stage | [ ] |  
| WH-009 | Sentrais triggers email notification via Pitchtape |  
Vendor receives "Stage 2: Validation" email | [ ] |  
| WH-010 | End-to-end: Submission → Review → Advance → Notify |  
All steps complete, Evidence Ledger contains full audit trail | [  
] |
```

****Test Environment**:** Sentrais staging environment
(`sentrais-staging.nfl360.aws.vpc.internal`)

****Test Data**:** Same 5 test submissions from Phase 1

6.3 Phase 3: Load Testing (Week 4)

****Objective**:** Validate system performance under expected load

****Load Profile**:**

- 100 submissions in 24-hour period (January 15, 2026 launch day)
- 500 submissions over 30-day period (submission window)
- 20 concurrent reviewers
- 50 webhook deliveries per hour (peak)

****Performance Targets**:**

- Submission form load time: <2 seconds
- Video upload (100MB): <30 seconds
- Webhook delivery latency: <5 seconds
- Reviewer workspace load time: <3 seconds
- AI summary generation: <10 seconds

****Load Testing Tools**:**

- k6 (open-source load testing)
- AWS CloudWatch (monitoring)
- DataDog APM (application performance)

6.4 Phase 4: Security Audit (Week 4)

****Objective**:** Validate security controls

****Audit Scope**:**

- HMAC signature validation
- SQL injection prevention
- XSS (cross-site scripting) prevention
- API rate limiting
- Data encryption (in transit and at rest)
- Access control (role-based permissions)

****Audit Deliverable**:** Security assessment report (pass/fail, remediation if needed)

****Auditor**:** NFL IT Security team + NOVATE CISO (Jeff Cratty)

Section 7: Support & Escalation

7.1 Support Contacts

****Pitchtape Support**:**

- ****Primary Contact**:** [Pitchtape Account Manager]
- ****Email**:** [support@pitchtape.com]
- ****Phone**:** [Pitchtape Support Phone]
- ****SLA**:** 24-hour response for Tier 1 issues, 4-hour response for Tier 0 (production down)

****NOVATE Support**** (Sentrais Integration):

- ****Primary Contact****: Tye Hayes (CEO)
- ****Email****: tye@novate.com
- ****Phone****: [Tye's Direct Line]
- ****Backup Contact****: Jeff Cratty (CTO)
- ****Email****: jeff@novate.com

****NFL Stakeholder Contacts****:

- ****Program Lead****: Tracy Rodberg (SVP Innovation)
- ****Commercial Lead****: Dan
- ****IT Lead****: Aaron Amendola
- ****Media Lead****: Brad Boim

7.2 Escalation Matrix

Issue Severity	Response Time	Escalation Path
----- ----- -----		
Tier 0 (Critical) : Production down, no submissions possible		
1 hour	Pitchtape Support → NOVATE (Tye) → NFL IT (Aaron)	
Tier 1 (High) : Webhooks failing, data loss risk	4 hours	
Pitchtape Support → NOVATE (Tye/Jeff)		
Tier 2 (Medium) : UI bugs, slow performance	24 hours	
Pitchtape Support → NOVATE (Tye)		
Tier 3 (Low) : Feature requests, cosmetic issues	5	
business days Pitchtape Support		

Section 8: Configuration Checklist

****Pitchtape Configuration Completion****:

- [] Workspace created (`nfl-draft-2026.pitchtape.com`)

- [] Custom branding applied (NFL Innovation HUB logo, colors)
- [] **6-step** submission form configured (all fields, validation rules)
- [] Applicant dashboard configured (status tracking, progress visualization)
- [] Reviewer accounts created (**9** reviewers: IT, Ops, Media, Sponsorship, Admin)
- [] Reviewer workspace configured (unified review interface, AI summaries)
- [] Evaluation criteria configured (role-specific criteria, weighted scoring)
- [] AI summary generator configured (OpenAI integration, prompt template)
- [] Q&A system configured (structured questions, vendor responses)
- [] Email templates configured (**7** templates: stage transitions, Q&A, demos, decline, winner)
- [] Webhook endpoints configured (submission, review, Q&A → Sentrais)
- [] HMAC signature authentication enabled (shared secret provided)
- [] API client credentials provided (for Sentrais → Pitchtape status updates)
- [] Data export endpoint confirmed (for Q4 **2026** migration)

****Sentrais Integration Completion**:**

- [] Sentrais database schema deployed (PostgreSQL + TimescaleDB)
- [] AWS API Gateway configured (public webhook receiver)
- [] Lambda function deployed (HMAC validation, VPC forwarding)
- [] Sentrais webhook receiver endpoints deployed (`/submissions/ingest`, `/evidence/reviewer-activity`, `/evidence/qa-response`)
- [] Sentrais → Pitchtape API client configured (status updates, notifications)

- [] Stage gate logic implemented (auto-qualification, Stage 1 → Stage 2 transition)
- [] Evidence Ledger ingestion pipeline deployed (all Pitchtape events logged)
- [] NFL360 dashboard embedding configured (iframe + SSO)
- [] VPC peering established (NFL corporate VPC ↔ NFL Innovation HUB VPC)

****Testing Completion**:**

- [] Phase 1: Pitchtape configuration testing (10 test cases passed)
- [] Phase 2: Webhook integration testing (10 test cases passed)
- [] Phase 3: Load testing (performance targets met)
- [] Phase 4: Security audit (no critical vulnerabilities)

****Go-Live Readiness**:**

- [] NFL stakeholders trained (reviewer accounts, dashboard access)
- [] Test submissions archived (5 test submissions deleted from production)
- [] Monitoring enabled (DataDog, CloudWatch, PagerDuty alerts)
- [] Support contacts confirmed (Pitchtape, NOVATE, NFL)
- [] January 15, 2026 launch announcement prepared (email to potential vendors)

Appendices

Appendix A: Submission Form Field Mapping

****Pitchtape Field ID → Sentrais Database Column**:**

Pitchtape Field	Sentrais Table	Sentrais Column
-----------------	----------------	-----------------

```
|-----|-----|-----|
| `company_name` | `vendors` | `company_name` |
| `innovation_name` | `innovations` | `name` |
| `tagline` | `innovations` | `tagline` |
| `primary_category` | `innovations` | `category` |
| `mvp_status` | `innovations` | `mvp_status` |
| `pitch_video` | `innovations` | `video_url` |
| `pitch_deck` | `innovations` | `pitch_deck_url` |
| `onepass_components` | `innovations` | `onepass_integration`
(JSONB) |
| `integration_approach` | `innovations` | `onepass_integration`
(JSONB) |
| `team_members` | `vendors` | `team` (JSONB) |
| `company_stage` | `vendors` | `company_stage` |
| `company_location` | `vendors` | `location` |
| `company_website` | `vendors` | `website` |
```

Appendix B: Email Template Examples

****Stage Transition Email (Discovery → Validation)**:**
...

Subject: 🏈 You've Advanced to Stage **2**: Validation (Combine)

Hi [Vendor First Name],

Congratulations! Your innovation, [Innovation Name], has successfully completed Stage **1**: Discovery (Scouting) and advanced to Stage **2**: Validation (Combine).

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

Stage 2: Validation (Combine)

You'll participate in NFL-controlled proof-of-concept (POC) testing to validate your solution's capabilities against real-world scenarios.

Next Steps:

1. Schedule Your Demo (within 48 hours)

[Schedule Demo →]

2. Review Demo Preparation Guide

[View Guide →]

3. Prepare for Technical Q&A

NFL stakeholders (IT, Operations, Media, Sponsorship) will evaluate your solution.

Demo Date: [Proposed Date/Time]

Duration: 2 hours

Format: Virtual (Zoom) or In-Person (your choice)

Questions? Contact innovationhub@nfl.com

Good luck in the Combine!

The NFL Innovation HUB Team

^^^

Appendix C: Reviewer Training Slide Deck (5 slides)

Slide 1: Welcome Reviewers

...

You're Reviewing the Future of NFL Innovation

Your Role:

- Evaluate submissions based on your domain expertise
- Provide ratings and feedback within **7** days of assignment
- Ask vendors clarifying questions via structured Q&A

Your Impact:

- Your evaluations determine which innovations advance to POC testing
- You're shaping the NFL's technology ecosystem for the next **5** years

...

****Slide 2: Reviewer Workspace Tour****

...

[Screenshot of unified review interface]

Key Features:

- Video player (watch pitch)
- AI-generated summary (quick overview)
- Pitch deck viewer (PDF inline)
- OnePass integration details
- Your evaluation form (role-specific criteria)

...

****Slide 3: Evaluation Criteria (Example: IT Lead)****

...

Your Criteria (Weighted):

- 1.** Technical Readiness (**40%**) - Can this scale to NFL requirements?
- 2.** OnePass Integration (**30%**) - How easily does it integrate?
- 3.** Security & Compliance (**20%**) - Does it meet NFL standards?
- 4.** Data Architecture (**10%**) - Is the data model sound?

Rate each criterion 1-5 stars + comment
Confidence Level: Low / Medium / High
Open Questions: Ask vendors clarifying questions
...

****Slide 4: Structured Q&A****
...

How to Ask Questions:

1. Enter question in "Open Questions" field
2. Vendor receives email notification
3. Vendor responds via dashboard
4. All reviewers see response (transparency)

Example Questions:

- "Can you provide SOC2 compliance documentation?"
 - "How do you handle stadium-specific customization?"
 - "What's your disaster recovery plan?"
- ...

****Slide 5: Review Deadlines & Support****
...

Timeline:

- Submissions open: January 15, 2026
- Your reviews due: 7 days after assignment
- Stage 2 (Validation): February-March 2026
- Draft Day: April 24, 2026

Support:

- Technical Issues: innovationhub@nfl.com
- Questions: Tye Hayes (tye@novate.com)

Let's find the next generation of NFL innovation!

Document Sign-Off

Prepared By:

- Tye Hayes, CEO, NOVATE Labs
- Jeff Cratty, CTO, NOVATE Labs

Reviewed By:

- Tracy Rodberg, SVP Innovation, NFL
- Dan, Commercial Lead, NFL
- Aaron Amendola, IT Lead, NFL

Approved By:

- [NFL Executive Signature]

Effective Date: January 15, 2026

Version History:

- v1.0 (January 8, 2026): Initial release
-

End of Onboarding Documentation

Section 3: API Integration & Webhook Configuration

3.1 Sentrais Webhook Endpoints (Pitchtape → Sentrais)

Sentrais Base URL:

<https://sentrais.nfl360.aws.vpc.internal/api/orchestration>

Note: Sentrais is hosted in NFL's AWS VPC. Pitchtape must be whitelisted in NFL's security group to send webhooks. Provide Pitchtape's outbound IP addresses for whitelisting.

Webhook 1: Submission Ingestion

Event: Submission completed (all 6 steps, Terms accepted)

Pitchtape Webhook URL: POST

<https://sentrais.nfl360.aws.vpc.internal/api/orchestration/submissions/ingest>

Authentication: HMAC-SHA256 signature (shared secret: [REDACTED - provided separately])

Payload:

json

```
JSON
{
  "event_type": "submission.completed",
  "timestamp": "2026-01-28T14:32:00Z",
  "pitchtape_submission_id": "PT-2026-0128",
  "initiative": {
    "id": "nfl-draft-challenge-2026",
    "name": "NFL Draft Innovation Challenge 2026"
  },
  "vendor": {
    "company_name": "TGI Virtual Signage",
    "contact_email": "contact@tgi.com",
    "contact_phone": "+1-555-123-4567",
    "website": "https://tgi.com",
    "location": "San Francisco, CA",
    "company_stage": "Series A",
    "customer_base": "B2B2C",
    "team_members": [
      {
        "name": "Jane Doe",
        "title": "CEO",
        "linkedin": "https://linkedin.com/in/janedoe",
        "bio": "Former VP Engineering at Google, 15 years ML/AI
experience..."
      }
    ]
  },
  "innovation": {
    "name": "AI-Powered Virtual Signage",
    "tagline": "Dynamic broadcast overlays driven by real-time
fan sentiment",
    "category": "fan_journey_personalization",
```

```

    "description": "Full text from submission form...",
    "mvp_status": "deployed_in_production",
    "video": {
      "url": "https://pitchtape-cdn.com/videos/PT-2026-0128.mp4",
      "duration_seconds": 167,
      "transcript": "Hi, I'm Jane Doe from TGI..."
    },
    "pitch_deck": {
      "url":
"https://pitchtape-cdn.com/files/PT-2026-0128-deck.pdf",
      "filename": "TGI_NFLDraft_Deck.pdf",
      "size_bytes": 5242880
    },
    "tech_architecture": {
      "url":
"https://pitchtape-cdn.com/files/PT-2026-0128-arch.pdf",
      "filename": "TGI_Architecture.pdf"
    },
    "demo_media": null
  },
  "onepass_integration": {
    "components": ["mobile_app", "web_platform",
"broadcast_media"],
    "integration_approach": "api_sdk",
    "similar_integration": {
      "has_experience": true,
      "description": "Integrated with NBA League Pass and MLB At
Bat using REST APIs"
    }
  },
  "submitted_at": "2026-01-28T14:32:00Z"
}

```

Expected Sentraix Response (201 Created):

json

JSON

```
{
  "innovation_id": "INNO-2026-0128",
  "orchestration_status": "discovery_submitted",
  "zone_placement": "incubation",
  "next_stage": "discovery_review",
  "assigned_reviewers": [
    "aaron.amendola@nfl.com",
    "tracy.rodberg@nfl.com",
    "brad.boim@nfl.com",
    "dan.commercial@nfl.com"
  ],
  "estimated_review_completion": "2026-02-15T00:00:00Z"
}
```

Error Handling:

- If Sentrais returns 4xx/5xx, Pitchtape should retry with exponential backoff (max 5 retries)
- Log webhook failures in Pitchtape admin console
- Notify NOVATE admin (tye@novate.com) if webhook fails after 5 retries

Webhook 2: Reviewer Activity Sync

Event: Reviewer submits evaluation (ratings + comments)

Pitchtape Webhook URL: POST

<https://sentrais.nfl360.aws.vpc.internal/api/orchestration/evidence/reviewer-activity>

Payload:

json

JSON

```
{
  "event_type": "review.submitted",
  "timestamp": "2026-02-05T09:15:00Z",
}
```

```
"pitchtape_submission_id": "PT-2026-0128",
"innovation_id": "INNO-2026-0128",
"reviewer": {
  "id": "aaron.amendola@nfl.com",
  "name": "Aaron Amendola",
  "role": "IT Lead"
},
"evaluation": {
  "criteria": {
    "technical_readiness": {
      "score": 4,
      "weight": 0.40,
      "comment": "Strong API design, needs security review"
    },
    "onepass_integration": {
      "score": 4,
      "weight": 0.30,
      "comment": "Clear integration path, standard REST"
    },
    "security_compliance": {
      "score": 3,
      "weight": 0.20,
      "comment": "SOC2 docs pending, needs follow-up"
    },
    "data_architecture": {
      "score": 5,
      "weight": 0.10,
      "comment": "Well-designed data model"
    }
  },
  "composite_score": 3.9,
  "confidence_level": "medium",
  "open_questions": "Can you provide SOC2 compliance documentation?",
```

```
    "ai_summary": "Solution demonstrates clear OnePass  
integration with REST API. Technical architecture is sound, but  
security compliance needs verification."  
  },  
  "submitted_at": "2026-02-05T09:15:00Z"  
}
```

Expected Sentrais Response (201 Created):

json

```
JSON  
{  
  "evidence_id": "EVID-2026-0432",  
  "stored_in_ledger": true,  
  "innovation_id": "INNO-2026-0128",  
  "all_reviewers_complete": false,  
  "completed_reviewers": 2,  
  "pending_reviewers": 3,  
  "stage_gate_status": "awaiting_additional_reviewers"  
}
```

Stage Gate Trigger:

- When `all_reviewers_complete == true`, Sentrais calculates composite score
- If `composite_score >= 75%` → Advance to Stage 2 (Validation)
- If `composite_score < 75%` → Request more info or decline

Webhook 3: Q&A Interaction

Event: Vendor responds to reviewer question

Pitchtape Webhook URL: POST

<https://sentrais.nfl360.aws.vpc.internal/api/orchestration/evidence/qa-response>

Payload:

json

JSON

```
{
  "event_type": "qa.vendor_response",
  "timestamp": "2026-02-07T14:20:00Z",
  "pitchtape_submission_id": "PT-2026-0128",
  "innovation_id": "INNO-2026-0128",
  "question_id": "QA-2026-0089",
  "reviewer": {
    "id": "aaron.amendola@nfl.com",
    "name": "Aaron Amendola",
    "role": "IT Lead"
  },
  "question": "Can you provide SOC2 compliance documentation?",
  "vendor_response": "Yes, we completed SOC2 Type II certification in August 2025. Attached is our audit report. [link]",
  "attachments": [
    {
      "url": "https://pitchtape-cdn.com/files/PT-2026-0128-soc2.pdf",
      "filename": "TGI_SOC2_Report_2025.pdf",
      "size_bytes": 1048576
    }
  ],
  "responded_at": "2026-02-07T14:20:00Z"
}
```

Expected Sentrais Response (201 Created):

json

JSON

```
{
  "evidence_id": "EVID-2026-0433",
  "stored_in_ledger": true,
  "qa_id": "QA-2026-0089",
}
```

```
    "status": "answered",
    "visible_to_all_reviewers": true
  }
  ...

```

3.2 Sentrais → Pitchtape API Calls (Status Updates)

****Sentrais API Client Configuration**:**

****Pitchtape API Base URL**:** `https://api.pitchtape.com/v1`

****Authentication**:** Bearer token (Pitchtape provides API key)

API Call 1: Update Submission Status

****Trigger**:** Sentrais advances submission to new stage

****Endpoint**:** `PATCH

`https://api.pitchtape.com/v1/submissions/{pitchtape_submission_id}/status``

****Headers**:**

...

Authorization: Bearer {PITCHTAPE_API_KEY}

Content-Type: application/json

Request Body:

json

JSON

{

```
"sentrais_innovation_id": "INNO-2026-0128",
"orchestration_status": "validation_in_progress",
"stage": 2,
"stage_name": "Validation (Combine)",
"applicant_visible_message": "Congratulations! Your innovation
has advanced to Stage 2: Validation. You'll receive a demo
scheduling email within 48 hours.",
"internal_notes": "POC testing with HawkEye, ChyronHego, and
Genius comparison framework",
"updated_at": "2026-02-10T10:00:00Z"
}
```

Expected Pitchtape Response (200 OK):

json

JSON

```
{
  "pitchtape_submission_id": "PT-2026-0128",
  "status_updated": true,
  "applicant_notified": true,
  "dashboard_updated": true
}
...
```

****Applicant Dashboard Update**:** Pitchtape should update dashboard to show:

...

CURRENT STATUS:  STAGE 2 - VALIDATION (COMBINE)

✓ Stage 1: Discovery Completed Feb 10, 2026

- Submission qualified
- Category alignment confirmed

↻ Stage 2: Validation In Progress

- Demo scheduled: [Awaiting confirmation]

- POC testing: Pending
- Outstanding questions: 0

 Stage 3: Evaluation	Pending
 Stage 4: Selection	Pending

API Call 2: Send Notification Email

Trigger: Sentrais needs to notify vendor (stage transition, demo invite, Q&A response)

Endpoint: POST <https://api.pitchtape.com/v1/notifications/send>

Request Body:

json

```
JSON
{
  "submission_id": "PT-2026-0128",
  "template": "stage_transition_validation",
  "recipient": "contact@tgi.com",
  "cc": ["jane.doe@tgi.com"],
  "data": {
    "vendor_name": "TGI Virtual Signage",
    "innovation_name": "AI-Powered Virtual Signage",
    "previous_stage": "Discovery (Scouting)",
    "new_stage": "Validation (Combine)",
    "next_steps": "Schedule your demo using this link:
https://nfl360.com/challenge/demos/INNO-2026-0128",
    "demo_prep_guide_url":
"https://nfl360.com/challenge/demo-guide",
    "contact_email": "innovationhub@nfl.com"
  }
}
```

Expected Pitchtape Response (201 Created):

json

JSON

```
{
  "notification_id": "NOTIF-2026-0234",
  "email_sent": true,
  "sent_at": "2026-02-10T10:05:00Z",
  "recipient": "contact@tgi.com",
  "cc": ["jane.doe@tgi.com"]
}
...
```

****Email Templates Required**** (Pitchtape Configuration):

1. `stage\_transition\_validation` (Discovery → Validation)
2. `stage\_transition\_evaluation` (Validation → Evaluation)
3. `stage\_transition\_selection` (Evaluation → Selection)
4. `demo\_invitation` (Validation stage demo scheduling)
5. `reviewer\_question` (Q&A from reviewer)
6. `decline\_notification` (Did not advance from Discovery)
7. `winner\_announcement` (Draft Day selection)

3.3 Webhook Security Configuration

****Authentication Method****: HMAC-SHA256 signature

****Shared Secret****: `[REDACTED - provided via secure channel]`

****Signature Header****: `X-Pitchtape-Signature`

****Signature Algorithm****:

...

HMAC-SHA256(shared_secret, request_body_json)

Sentrais Verification Logic:

javascript

JavaScript

```
const crypto = require('crypto');

function verifyWebhook(req) {
  const signature = req.headers['x-pitchtape-signature'];
  const body = JSON.stringify(req.body);
  const expectedSignature = crypto
    .createHmac('sha256', SHARED_SECRET)
    .update(body)
    .digest('hex');

  return signature === expectedSignature;
}
```

IP Whitelisting:

- Pitchtape Outbound IPs: [Pitchtape to provide]
 - Add to NFL AWS VPC Security Group inbound rules (HTTPS only, port 443)
-

Section 4: Data Export & Migration Planning

4.1 Data Export Requirements (for Pitchtape Deprecation)

Export Trigger: Q4 2026 (when custom Sentrais intake module is ready)

Export Format: JSON (line-delimited, one submission per line)

Export Endpoint: GET <https://api.pitchtape.com/v1/exports/submissions>

Query Parameters:

- `initiative_id=nfl-draft-challenge-2026`
- `format=jsonl` (JSON Lines)
- `include_files=true` (download URLs for videos, decks)

Expected Export Structure:

json

JSON

```
{
  "pitchtape_submission_id": "PT-2026-0128",
  "submitted_at": "2026-01-28T14:32:00Z",
  "vendor": { ... },
  "innovation": { ... },
  "reviews": [
    {
      "reviewer_id": "aaron.amendola@nfl.com",
      "submitted_at": "2026-02-05T09:15:00Z",
      "evaluation": { ... }
    }
  ],
  "qa_thread": [
    {
      "question_id": "QA-2026-0089",
      "question": "...",
      "response": "...",
      "timestamps": { ... }
    }
  ],
  "status_history": [
    {
      "status": "discovery_submitted",
      "timestamp": "2026-01-28T14:32:00Z"
    },
    {
      "status": "validation_in_progress",
      "timestamp": "2026-02-10T10:00:00Z"
    }
  ]
}
...
```

****File Download**:** All videos and PDFs must remain accessible via CDN URLs for **12** months post-export

4.2 Historical Data Retention

****NFL Requirement****: All submissions, reviews, videos, and Q&A threads must be archived in Sentrais

****Archive Location****: AWS S3
(`s3://nfl-innovation-hub-archive/pitchtape-2026/`)

****Retention Policy****: 7 years (NFL standard for vendor evaluation records)

****Migration Script****: NOVATE provides Python script to import Pitchtape export into Sentrais database

Section 5: NFL Access Model (AWS VPC Integration)

5.1 Network Architecture

****Sentrais Hosting****:

- ****AWS Region****: us-east-1 (Virginia)
- ****VPC****: NFL Innovation HUB VPC (`vpc-nfl-innohub-prod`)
- ****Subnets****: Private subnets (no direct internet access)
- ****Load Balancer****: Application Load Balancer (ALB) in public subnet
- ****Domain****: `sentrais.nfl360.aws.vpc.internal` (internal DNS only)

****NFL360 Dashboard Embedding****:

- NFL360 frontend (hosted in NFL corporate VPC) embeds Sentrais dashboards via iframe
- Authentication: NFL365 SSO (Azure AD SAML integration)

- Network: VPC peering between NFL corporate VPC and NFL Innovation HUB VPC

5.2 NFL Stakeholder Access

****Access Method****: NFL360 web application (browser-based, no VPN required)

****Authentication Flow****:

...

NFL Stakeholder logs into NFL360

↓

Azure AD SSO (SAML)

↓

NFL360 validates user (Tracy, Dan, Aaron, Brad, etc.)

↓

NFL360 embeds Sentrais dashboard (iframe)

↓

Sentrai validates JWT token (issued by NFL360)

↓

User sees role-appropriate dashboard (Executive, PMO, Reviewer)

...

****No VPN Required****: All access via HTTPS through NFL corporate network

****Mobile Access****: NFL360 mobile app (iOS/Android) also embeds Sentrais dashboards

5.3 Pitchtape → Sentrais Network Path

****Challenge**:** Pitchtape (external SaaS) needs to send webhooks to Sentrais (internal VPC)

****Solution**:** AWS API Gateway as public-facing webhook receiver

****Architecture**:**

```

Pitchtape (internet)

↓ HTTPS POST (webhook)

AWS API Gateway (public endpoint)

- URL:

`https://api-gateway.nfl-innohub.aws.com/webhooks/pitchtape`

- Authentication: HMAC signature validation

↓ Forward to internal VPC

AWS Lambda (VPC-attached)

- Validates HMAC signature

- Forwards to Sentrais internal endpoint

↓

Sentrais (private VPC)

- URL:

`http://sentrais-internal-alb.vpc.internal/api/orchestration/...`

```

****Pitchtape Configuration**:**

- ****Webhook URL**:**

``https://api-gateway.nfl-innohub.aws.com/webhooks/pitchtape/submissions``

- ****Authentication**:** HMAC-SHA256 (shared secret)

- ****IP Whitelisting**:** Not required (API Gateway is public, but HMAC-protected)

Section 6: Testing & Validation Plan

6.1 Phase 1: Pitchtape Configuration Testing (Week 1)

****Objective**:** Validate Pitchtape workspace configuration

****Test Cases**:**

Test ID	Test Case	Expected Result	Pass/Fail
PT-001	Create test submission (all 6 steps)	Submission ID generated, confirmation email sent	[]
PT-002	Upload 3-minute video	Video uploaded, playback works in dashboard	[]
PT-003	Upload pitch deck PDF (50MB)	PDF uploaded, viewable in reviewer workspace	[]
PT-004	Conditional logic: Select "Concept stage" MVP	Form blocks submission, displays disqualification message	[]
PT-005	Applicant dashboard displays submission status	Dashboard shows "Stage 1: Discovery (Scouting)"	[]
PT-006	Reviewer login and assignment	Reviewer sees assigned submissions in workspace	[]
PT-007	Reviewer submits evaluation (4 stars, comment)	Evaluation saved, confirmation displayed	[]
PT-008	AI summary generation	Summary appears in reviewer workspace	[]
PT-009	Q&A: Reviewer asks question	Vendor receives email notification, can respond in dashboard	[]
PT-010	Q&A: Vendor responds	All reviewers see response in workspace	[]

****Test Submissions**:** NOVATE creates 5 test submissions with realistic data

****Test Reviewers**:** Aaron, Tracy, Brad, Dan, Tye (5 real NFL stakeholders)

6.2 Phase 2: Webhook Integration Testing (Week 2-3)

****Objective**:** Validate Pitchtape → Sentrais webhook delivery

****Test Cases**:**

Test ID	Test Case	Expected Result	Pass/Fail
WH-001	Submission completed webhook fires	Sentrais receives submission data, returns 201 Created	[]
WH-002	Sentrais creates innovation record	innovation_id generated, data stored in PostgreSQL	[]
WH-003	Reviewer evaluation webhook fires	Sentrais receives evaluation data, stores in Evidence Ledger	[]
WH-004	All reviewers complete → Stage gate trigger	Sentrais calculates composite score, advances to Stage 2	[]
WH-005	Q&A response webhook fires	Sentrais stores Q&A in Evidence Ledger	[]
WH-006	HMAC signature validation	Invalid signature rejected with 401 Unauthorized	[]
WH-007	Webhook retry on failure	Pitchtape retries with exponential backoff (5 retries max)	[]
WH-008	Sentrais pushes status update to Pitchtape	Applicant dashboard updates to show new stage	[]
WH-009	Sentrais triggers email notification via Pitchtape	Vendor receives "Stage 2: Validation" email	[]
WH-010	End-to-end: Submission → Review → Advance → Notify	All steps complete, Evidence Ledger contains full audit trail	[]

****Test Environment**:** Sentrais staging environment
(`sentrais-staging.nfl360.aws.vpc.internal`)

****Test Data**:** Same 5 test submissions from Phase 1

6.3 Phase 3: Load Testing (Week 4)

****Objective**:** Validate system performance under expected load

****Load Profile**:**

- 100 submissions in 24-hour period (January 15, 2026 launch day)
- 500 submissions over 30-day period (submission window)
- 20 concurrent reviewers
- 50 webhook deliveries per hour (peak)

****Performance Targets**:**

- Submission form load time: <2 seconds
- Video upload (100MB): <30 seconds
- Webhook delivery latency: <5 seconds
- Reviewer workspace load time: <3 seconds
- AI summary generation: <10 seconds

****Load Testing Tools**:**

- k6 (open-source load testing)
- AWS CloudWatch (monitoring)
- DataDog APM (application performance)

6.4 Phase 4: Security Audit (Week 4)

****Objective**:** Validate security controls

****Audit Scope**:**

- HMAC signature validation
- SQL injection prevention
- XSS (cross-site scripting) prevention
- API rate limiting
- Data encryption (in transit and at rest)
- Access control (role-based permissions)

****Audit Deliverable****: Security assessment report (pass/fail, remediation if needed)

****Auditor****: NFL IT Security team + NOVATE CISO (Jeff Cratty)

Section 7: Support & Escalation

7.1 Support Contacts

****Pitchtape Support****:

- ****Primary Contact****: [Pitchtape Account Manager]
- ****Email****: [support@pitchtape.com]
- ****Phone****: [Pitchtape Support Phone]
- ****SLA****: 24-hour response for Tier 1 issues, 4-hour response for Tier 0 (production down)

****NOVATE Support**** (Sentrais Integration):

- ****Primary Contact****: Tye Hayes (CEO)
- ****Email****: tye@novate.com
- ****Phone****: [Tye's Direct Line]
- ****Backup Contact****: Jeff Cratty (CTO)
- ****Email****: jeff@novate.com

****NFL Stakeholder Contacts****:

- ****Program Lead****: Tracy Rodberg (SVP Innovation)
- ****Commercial Lead****: Dan
- ****IT Lead****: Aaron Amendola
- ****Media Lead****: Brad Boim

7.2 Escalation Matrix

Issue Severity	Response Time	Escalation Path
----- ----- -----		
Tier 0 (Critical): Production down, no submissions possible		
1 hour	Pitchtape Support → NOVATE (Tye) → NFL IT (Aaron)	
Tier 1 (High): Webhooks failing, data loss risk 4 hours		
Pitchtape Support → NOVATE (Tye/Jeff)		
Tier 2 (Medium): UI bugs, slow performance 24 hours		
Pitchtape Support → NOVATE (Tye)		
Tier 3 (Low): Feature requests, cosmetic issues 5		
business days Pitchtape Support		

Section 8: Configuration Checklist

Pitchtape Configuration Completion:

- [] Workspace created (`nfl-draft-2026.pitchtape.com`)
- [] Custom branding applied (NFL Innovation HUB logo, colors)
- [] 6-step submission form configured (all fields, validation rules)
- [] Applicant dashboard configured (status tracking, progress visualization)
- [] Reviewer accounts created (9 reviewers: IT, Ops, Media, Sponsorship, Admin)
- [] Reviewer workspace configured (unified review interface, AI summaries)
- [] Evaluation criteria configured (role-specific criteria, weighted scoring)
- [] AI summary generator configured (OpenAI integration, prompt template)
- [] Q&A system configured (structured questions, vendor responses)
- [] Email templates configured (7 templates: stage transitions, Q&A, demos, decline, winner)

- [] Webhook endpoints configured (submission, review, Q&A → Sentrais)
- [] HMAC signature authentication enabled (shared secret provided)
- [] API client credentials provided (for Sentrais → Pitchtape status updates)
- [] Data export endpoint confirmed (for Q4 2026 migration)

****Sentrais Integration Completion**:**

- [] Sentrais database schema deployed (PostgreSQL + TimescaleDB)
- [] AWS API Gateway configured (public webhook receiver)
- [] Lambda function deployed (HMAC validation, VPC forwarding)
- [] Sentrais webhook receiver endpoints deployed (`/submissions/ingest`, `/evidence/reviewer-activity`, `/evidence/qa-response`)
- [] Sentrais → Pitchtape API client configured (status updates, notifications)
- [] Stage gate logic implemented (auto-qualification, Stage 1 → Stage 2 transition)
- [] Evidence Ledger ingestion pipeline deployed (all Pitchtape events logged)
- [] NFL360 dashboard embedding configured (iframe + SS0)
- [] VPC peering established (NFL corporate VPC ↔ NFL Innovation HUB VPC)

****Testing Completion**:**

- [] Phase 1: Pitchtape configuration testing (10 test cases passed)
- [] Phase 2: Webhook integration testing (10 test cases passed)
- [] Phase 3: Load testing (performance targets met)
- [] Phase 4: Security audit (no critical vulnerabilities)

****Go-Live Readiness**:**

- [] NFL stakeholders trained (reviewer accounts, dashboard access)
- [] Test submissions archived (5 test submissions deleted from production)
- [] Monitoring enabled (DataDog, CloudWatch, PagerDuty alerts)
- [] Support contacts confirmed (Pitchtape, NOVATE, NFL)
- [] January 15, 2026 launch announcement prepared (email to potential vendors)

Appendices

Appendix A: Submission Form Field Mapping

****Pitchtape Field ID → Sentrais Database Column**:**

Pitchtape Field	Sentrais Table	Sentrais Column
-----	-----	-----
`company_name`	`vendors`	`company_name`
`innovation_name`	`innovations`	`name`
`tagline`	`innovations`	`tagline`
`primary_category`	`innovations`	`category`
`mvp_status`	`innovations`	`mvp_status`
`pitch_video`	`innovations`	`video_url`
`pitch_deck`	`innovations`	`pitch_deck_url`
`onepass_components`	`innovations`	`onepass_integration` (JSONB)
`integration_approach`	`innovations`	`onepass_integration` (JSONB)
`team_members`	`vendors`	`team` (JSONB)
`company_stage`	`vendors`	`company_stage`
`company_location`	`vendors`	`location`
`company_website`	`vendors`	`website`

Appendix B: Email Template Examples

****Stage Transition Email (Discovery → Validation)**:**

...

Subject: 🏈 You've Advanced to Stage **2**: Validation (Combine)

Hi [Vendor First Name],

Congratulations! Your innovation, [Innovation Name], has successfully completed Stage **1**: Discovery (Scouting) and advanced to Stage **2**: Validation (Combine).

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

Stage **2**: Validation (Combine)

You'll participate in NFL-controlled proof-of-concept (POC) testing to validate your solution's capabilities against real-world scenarios.

Next Steps:

1. Schedule Your Demo (within **48** hours)
[Schedule Demo →]

2. Review Demo Preparation Guide
[View Guide →]

3. Prepare for Technical Q&A
NFL stakeholders (IT, Operations, Media, Sponsorship) will evaluate your solution.

Demo Date: [Proposed Date/Time]

Duration: 2 hours

Format: Virtual (Zoom) or In-Person (your choice)

Questions? Contact innovationhub@nfl.com

Good luck in the Combine!

The NFL Innovation HUB Team

^^^

Appendix C: Reviewer Training Slide Deck (5 slides)

****Slide 1: Welcome Reviewers****

^^^

You're Reviewing the Future of NFL Innovation

Your Role:

- Evaluate submissions based on your domain expertise
- Provide ratings and feedback within 7 days of assignment
- Ask vendors clarifying questions via structured Q&A

Your Impact:

- Your evaluations determine which innovations advance to POC testing
- You're shaping the NFL's technology ecosystem for the next 5 years

^^^

****Slide 2: Reviewer Workspace Tour****

^^^

[Screenshot of unified review interface]

Key Features:

- Video player (watch pitch)
 - AI-generated summary (quick overview)
 - Pitch deck viewer (PDF inline)
 - OnePass integration details
 - Your evaluation form (role-specific criteria)
- ...

****Slide 3: Evaluation Criteria (Example: IT Lead)****

...

Your Criteria (Weighted):

1. Technical Readiness (40%) - Can this scale to NFL requirements?
2. OnePass Integration (30%) - How easily does it integrate?
3. Security & Compliance (20%) - Does it meet NFL standards?
4. Data Architecture (10%) - Is the data model sound?

Rate each criterion 1-5 stars + comment

Confidence Level: Low / Medium / High

Open Questions: Ask vendors clarifying questions

...

****Slide 4: Structured Q&A****

...

How to Ask Questions:

1. Enter question in "Open Questions" field
2. Vendor receives email notification
3. Vendor responds via dashboard
4. All reviewers see response (transparency)

Example Questions:

- "Can you provide SOC2 compliance documentation?"
- "How do you handle stadium-specific customization?"
- "What's your disaster recovery plan?"

...

****Slide 5: Review Deadlines & Support****

...

Timeline:

- Submissions open: January 15, 2026
- Your reviews due: 7 days after assignment
- Stage 2 (Validation): February-March 2026
- Draft Day: April 24, 2026

Support:

- Technical Issues: innovationhub@nfl.com
- Questions: Tye Hayes (tye@novate.com)

Let's find the next generation of NFL innovation!

Document Sign-Off

Prepared By:

- Tye Hayes, CEO, NOVATE Labs

Reviewed By:

- Gary Brantley, SVP + CIO, NFL
- Tracy Rodberg, SVP Innovation, NFL
- Jason, Sponsorship Lead, NFL
- Aaron Amendola, IT Lead, NFL

Approved By:

- [NFL Executive Signature]

Effective Date: January 15, 2026

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- v1.0 (January 8, 2026): Initial release

End of Onboarding Documentation